

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Do you know what it takes to become an environmental activist?



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe events in the news in a range of social and work contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about feelings and impressions.
- I can exchange opinions.
- I can ask for clarification.

Ask your partner:

- Which social causes do you support? Why?
- What do you do every day to protect the environment?





Let's Explore!

Sally finds out more about Rachel Carson and her fight against the chemical industry **lobby***.

* A "lobby" is a group of individuals or companies trying to influence the public or the government on a particular issue.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** John, do you remember the first time you felt inspired by Carson's actions?
- John Smits:** Certainly. With the publication of *The Sea Around Us* in 1951, Carson was able to devote all of her time to writing. This quote summarizes her goal: "If people show more respect for nature, everybody will be able to live peacefully with it."
- Sally:** Do you know if anything motivated her to become an activist?
- John Smits:** It all began with a letter from a friend who owned a bird sanctuary. She found out that a local government agency sprayed an enormous amount of pesticide, killing many birds. She felt compelled to investigate. She believed that if she found evidence about what caused the animals to die, she would be able to prove that pesticides were harmful to the earth.
- Sally:** Can you tell us what happened afterwards?
- John Smits:** She published a book on her findings, which became controversial. Environmentalists stressed the importance of her work, while chemical companies dubbed her a fanatic. Nevertheless, a study later demonstrated that her facts were correct.
- Sally:** Do you think that Carson is still relevant today?
- John Smits:** Absolutely. Her work is compelling. If we ignored her commitment to the environment, her campaigning against the death of American wildlife would be in vain.





Let's Practice!

John Smits explains the dangers of overfishing.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence. Rewrite the sentence in the correct order.

1. fish / continue / oceans, / will / die / the / the / pollute / . / If / to / we

2. be / fish / no / . / will / one / day, / overfish, / left / continue / there / If / to / we

3. Sea / Us, / I / read / The / If / I / . / Around / respect / would / for / more / have / nature

4. listened / a / to / . / Carson, / place / If / world / would / the / Rachel / better / be / people



Let's Practice!

Sally thinks the conversation will be inspiring for her readers!

Instructions: Read the sentences. Write the missing words, choose from you felt inspired by, if anything motivated her, she felt compelled, the environment is compelling, and is always inspiring.

1. Do you remember the first time _____ Carson's actions?
2. Do you know _____ to become an activist?
3. _____ to investigate the problem.
4. Her work on _____.
5. Being an environmental activist _____.





Extension Activity

Make a chain story talking about hypothetical situations.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Begin with a sentence, for example: *"If I won a million dollars, I would travel around the world."*
- Your partner must use the end of the previous sentence to begin their own sentence. *"If I traveled around the world, I would visit Japan."*
- Continue back and forth with your partner for five rounds.
- Start your chain using one of these prompts:
 - If I won the lottery ...
 - If I were the leader of my country ...
 - If I visited the U.S. next week ...

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about feelings and impressions.

☐ ☐

I exchange opinions.

☐ ☐

I talk about hypothetical situations.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **sanctuary** (noun): a place of refuge or safety
e.g. Rachel Carson became an activist after she visited a bird sanctuary.
- **to spray** (verb): to apply a liquid or gas in the form of a shower of tiny drops or particles
e.g. She found out that a local government agency sprayed an enormous amount of harmful substance in the air.
- **pesticide** (noun): a substance used to destroy insects and other harmful organisms
e.g. She found out that a local government agency sprayed an enormous amount of pesticide.
- **compelled** (adjective): forced or obliged to do something
e.g. She felt compelled to investigate.
- **evidence** (noun): the available facts indicating a belief is valid; proof
e.g. If she found evidence about what caused the animals to die, she would be able to prove that pesticides were harmful to the earth.
- **controversial** (adjective): likely to raise public disagreement
e.g. She published a book on her findings, which became controversial.
- **fanatic** (noun): showing excessive enthusiasm in something
e.g. Environmentalists stressed the importance of her work, while chemical companies dubbed her a fanatic.





Learning Points

Conditional Sentences with *If* Clause

You use the first conditional with *If* clauses to talk about real possibilities in the future.

You use the second conditional to talk about unreal or imaginary (hypothetical) situations in the future.

You use the First Conditional to say it's possible that you will do or not do something. In that condition, something else may, will or will not happen.

The parts of the sentence are divided into two clauses: the *If* clause and the *Condition* clause.

You use the Second Conditional to talk about hypothetical situations. It's not certain that it's possible to fulfill the condition.

Example:

If I had a million dollars, I would buy a car.

Do you have a million dollars? No.

Is it possible to suddenly get a million dollars? Not really.

What would you do if you had a million dollars? Buy a car.

You use the **Simple Past verb + *would***

First Conditional: 1st Clause	First Conditional: 2nd Clause	Meaning
<i>If people show more respect for nature,</i>	<i>everybody will be able to live peacefully with it.</i>	It's possible that people show more respect for nature. In this condition, everybody will be able to live peacefully.
Second Conditional: <i>If ... + Simple Past</i>	Second Conditional: <i>would + base verb</i>	Result
<i>If we ignored her commitment to the environment,</i>	<i>her campaigning would be in vain.</i>	It is not certain that we ignore her commitment. What would happen if it did? Her campaigning would be in vain.





Learning Points

Questions within Sentences

You ask for clarification when you want more details of what the other person is talking about.

We often ask for clarification when we are not clear on what the other person is referring to. We ask the other person to be more specific by giving more information.

You can use questions with sentences to ask for clarification. You ask a question including a sentence within the question, like *Do you know if anything motivated Rachel Carson to become an activist?*

Questions with sentences are called **embedded questions**.

You can use *embedded questions*, like *Can you tell me ... ?* or *Do you know if / which / what ... ?* to ask for clarification.

Look at the chart below for an explanation on how to make embedded questions.

Main Question	Embedded Question
Do you know ...	what / where / when / who / ... ?
Do you remember ...	what / where / when / who / ... ?
Can you tell me ...	what / where / when / who / ... ?
Could you tell me ...	what / where / when / who / ... ?

Examples:

- *Do you remember the first time you felt inspired by Carson's actions?*
- *Can you tell us what happened afterwards?*

